

Regular Meeting
November 20, 2017
School Committee Meeting
Council Chambers

The regular meeting of the Medford School Committee was called to order by Mayor Burke in the City Hall Council Chambers at 7:05 p.m. Those present were Ms. Cugno, Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Skerry, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke and Superintendent Belson. Medford High School student representative Justin Tseng was also present.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Mr. Skerry that the minutes of October 16, 2017 be approved:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Mr. Skerry seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto that the Bills/Transfer of Funds be approved:

Voted: That the Bills/Transfer of Funds be approved.

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Mr. Skerry seconded by MMs. Kreatz that the Payrolls be approved:

Voted: That the Payrolls be approved

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Ms. Mustone to suspend the rules to take papers out of order:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Report on Project 351

Superintendent Belson reported that Project 351 is a youth service organization dedicated to building unity and leadership through the yearlong engagement and enrichment of an 8th grade service Ambassador from every city and town in Massachusetts. Youth are selected by hometown educators for an exemplary ethic of service and the values of kindness, compassion, humility, and gratitude. Created as an event of Governor Patrick's second inaugural and now convened by Governor Baker, Project 351 is a statewide non-

profit that partners with an extraordinary community of educators, service and non-profit organizations, private sector and civic leaders, families, and volunteers to achieve this mission. The Ambassador year is one of impact, growth, and transformation. In partnership with non-profit leaders and educators, Project 351 challenges, motivates, and supports the young leader's journey as change agent. Each year, Ambassadors are invited to "unite, act, and lead" at a January celebration and service day in honor of Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr., Spring Leadership Reunion, and two signature statewide service days that hone leadership skills and scale impact for select non-profit partners. Through Project 351, youth develop confidence and compassion, build leadership and communication skills, engage peers and civic leaders in common purpose, and open hearts and minds with their passion for making a difference in their community and our world. And, they expand their horizons and sense of what is possible through friendships with diverse peers from every corner of Massachusetts and exposure to issues and opportunities that challenge and enrich. This year Medford will be represented by a student from each of our middle schools. The McGlynn Middle School has selected Sumaya Omi as Ambassador for Project 351. Sumaya is a very mature, respectful student who displays a strong work ethic. She has made honor roll or high honor roll every term in middle school and was inducted into the National Junior Honor Society last year. Sumaya loves art and is presently a member of our Printer's Club. She frequently performs community service activities by assisting her teachers. The Andrews has nominated Ava Heinig to serve as our ambassador for Project 351. She has distinguished herself as a person who is filled with passion, enthusiasm, and excitement being a student at the Andrews Middle School. Ava has earned great respect from the faculty and students by being critically open-minded about expanding the parameters of the overall operation of our school. Ava Heinig is an exceptional person who has earned school recognition for her commitment to others and her service to the community. Her cooperative spirit, her compassion for the well-being of all, and her flexible style make her an outstanding person who is destined for significant accomplishments. Superintendent Belson introduced Andrews Principal Paul D'Alleva and student Ava Heinig. Ava thanked the Andrews for selecting her to represent their school.

Discussion:

Ms. Cugno said that she has had the opportunity to attend the event and it is wonderful to see the camaraderie with the students. It is a great event.

On the motion of Ms. Cugno seconded by Ms. Mustone to accept report and place on file.

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Ms. Mustone seconded by Ms. Kreatz to revert back to the regular order of business:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Community Participation

Melanie McLaughlin was scheduled to speak but was ill. On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot the item was tabled.

Charlene Douglas, President of the Medford Teachers Association was given permission to speak. Ms. Douglas informed the Superintendent and the committee that the promised binders with the plan were ready and therefore handed out. Many teachers attended in support of the grievances. Ms. Douglas thanked them for their solidarity. Superintendent Belson stated that the date of December 6th has been scheduled to move forward.

Recommendation to Appoint Dr. Patrick Sabia as School Physician

Superintendent Belson stated that Dr. Kristen Goodell has accepted a new position as an Associate Dean of the Boston University Medical School. This leaves a vacancy that must be filled. Dr. Sabia is a very experienced professional with a Family Care and Pediatric practice located in Medford Square. I have interviewed Dr. Sabia and checked his references. I believe he will be an outstanding asset for our school system. Supervisor of Health Services Toni Vento introduced Dr. Sabia.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Mr. Skerry to appoint Dr. Patrick Sabia as School Physician:

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

Absent: 0

Ms. DiBenedetto asked when Dr. Sabia would be called. Ms. Vento answered that he would sit on the health advisory committee, update parental information forms and consult with the athletic trainer as needed.

Report on Tier II E-rate Funding Award

Director of Finance and Administration Kirsteen Patterson presented the report. Ms. Patterson stated that the federally funded Universal Service Administrative Company (USAC) has released their announcement for funding commitment of Medford's Category 2 service for 2017-2018. Category 2 services are competitive and based on project scope and local funding commitment for firewalls, wireless access points and switch replacements. Medford's discount rate is 60% based on prior year's low income percentages across the district. There is a significant amount of coordination, scheduling and vendor meetings that need to take place in order to get this project completed by the timeframe allotted. All funds must be encumbered by June 30, 2018 with committed purchase orders to vendors prior to that date in order to meet completion over the summer of 2018. It is recommended to move forward with the request of the matching funds from the city to maximize funds that may not be available in the future. This project will greatly improve the connectivity at all schools and provide more stable computing possibilities for students, teachers and staff.

Discussion:

Ms. Van der Kloot asked if we go to the city council for matching funds? Superintendent Belson answered yes.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Mr. Skerry for approval and send forward to council for matching funds totaling \$291,150:

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

Absent: 0

Ms. DiBenedetto commented that if school committee members are needed to go to the council she would attend. Ms. Cugno also volunteered.

Report on Veterans Day Program

Dr. Bernadette Riccardelli presented the report. She reported that The Medford Public Schools and The Office of Veterans Services have teamed up over the course of the past 17 years to provide students and faculty on the high school level the opportunity to learn about combat and non-combat related experiences of Medford's veterans. From all accounts the program has been enormously successful and has been fulfilling not only to our students and faculty but also to the participating veterans. This year's program occurred on Thursday, November 2, 2017 and was co-coordinated with the Director of Veterans Services, Mr. Earnest Lindsay. The day began at 7:30 AM in the superintendent's conference room with a light breakfast of coffee, donuts, juice, muffins, and fruit. Mayor Stephanie Muccini-Burke and School Committee member Kathy Kreatz greeted the veteran speakers and participated in the welcoming address which included the Pledge of Allegiance and a brief self-introduction by each participant. Twenty-seven veterans from several eras, including the Vietnam War, the Persian Gulf War, and the Iraq War visited thirty-eight classes and gave an overview of their military experiences and contributions. The program provides our students with an oral history of personal experiences that enhances their study of history in the classroom. Feedback from students, teachers, and veterans from this year's program has been overwhelmingly positive. We are thankful to Dunkin Donuts in West Medford for donating coffee and a generous assortment of muffins, bagels, and donuts. We would also like to thank grade 12 MVTHS student, Noah Kreatz for displaying many items from his vintage military collection and engaging our guests in meaningful conversations about the importance of historical artifacts in understanding our nation's history.

Discussion:

Ms. Cugno thanked the veterans and requested that a letter be sent to Mr. Lindsay. She asked if it would be possible to invite the children of WWII veterans. Dr. Ricciardelli said that is a wonderful suggestion. Ms. DiBenedetto requested that a letter be sent to Dunkin Donuts. Ms. Kreatz thanked everyone on behalf of her son, Noah.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot the report was accepted and placed on file:

Vote:

Yes: 7

No: 0

Absent: 0

Recommendation to Accept Major Gift from Stop & Shop to Vocational School and Food Service Program

Director of Finance and Administration Kirsteen Patterson reported that Stop & Shop is presenting a donation of \$10,000 for the Vocational School's new Bistro 489. Stop & Shop is also providing free school lunches to all students of the Medford Public School on December 21st.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry seconded by Ms. Cugno that the gift from Stop & Shop be accepted:

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

Absent: 0

Ms. DiBenedetto asked where the monies were being spent. Superintendent Belson answered on the construction of the deck. Ms. DiBenedetto asked that a letter of thanks be sent to Stop & Shop. The Grand Opening of Bistro 489 is scheduled for Dec. 4th at 11:00 a.m.

Recommendation to Approve Foreign Language NYC Trip

Director of Foreign Language Rita DiCarlo is requesting approval for a trip to New York City planned for December 17-18. This trip is specifically for Ms. Canetta's AP Italian class. In addition to Ms. Canetta, Ms. DiCarlo will also accompany the group as the second chaperone. The group consists of ten students and the trip will be at little or no cost to them since it is supported by a grant from the Michelina Pietrangelo Scholarship Fund.

On the motion of Ms. Cugno seconded by Ms. Mustone to approve the trip:

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

Absent: 0

Ms. Van der Kloot asked if they are traveling on a private bus. Ms. DiCarlo answered no that it leaves from South Station.

Report on Foreign Language Scholarship

Director of Foreign Language Rita DiCarlo presented the report. She stated that I am pleased to report that on the evening of October 7th one of our seniors, Sandra Figueroa was among the four students in the Boston area to be honored by the FAA-USA (Federazioni Associazioni Abruzzesi - Usa). This organization every year selects students who distinguish themselves in the study of Italian and awards them scholarships at their annual gala celebration. To qualify for the scholarship, Sandra had to have a high average in her AP Italian class and submit an essay on the importance of Italian to her. Sandra in her essay talked about her love for the Italian language, its culture, and of course, its food. She talked about how it is important to know more than one language and that she is proud to be trilingual. Often people ask her why she studies Italian when she already speaks English and Spanish. She answers that she wanted a challenge and is not sorry to have done it. At home she speaks Spanish and finds similarities between her culture and the Italian culture. At times she finds herself speaking Italian nonstop

and hopes that one day she will be able to visit the beautiful places in Italy of which she learned about in class. Sandra received a certificate and a \$1,000 scholarship at the FAA-USA's annual gala celebration which took place at Filippo's Restaurant in the North End of Boston. She was accompanied to the event by her father and her AP Italian teacher, Ms. Canetta. The four scholarships given that evening were made possible by the generosity of Joe Pace in memory of his mother. Joe Pace is the owner of Joe Pace & Son of Boston and Saugus.

Student Sandra Figueroa thanked (in Italian) the committee and Ms. DiCarlo for the honor.

Discussion:

Ms. Cugno thanked CASIT for the many opportunities they have given our students. Student Representative Justin Tseng commented that the students at Medford High are dedicated to learning foreign language thanks to Ms. DiCarlo. We all love you. As we move forward globally we need to continue with our learning of foreign languages.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto the report was accepted and placed on file.

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Recommendation to Approve SKILLS USA Conference Participation

Superintendent Belson reported that each year members of the student body of the vocational school attend the Fall State Leadership Conference in Marlborough, MA for SKILLS USA. The kickoff event will provide leadership training and activities for our students and advisors, as well as allow them to network with the other 55 vocational schools across the state. Funding for the conference will be paid through the Perkins grant.

Discussion:

Ms. Van der Kloot commented that the students left yesterday and we are receiving the request tonight. Superintendent Belson said that Mr. Fallon is new and still learning the procedures. It was requested that the students be invited to a future meeting.

On the motion of Ms. Cugno seconded by Ms. Kreatz approve the attendance at conference as amended:

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 0

Report of Professional Development Day November 7, 2017

Assistant Superintendent Diane Caldwell presented the report. She reported that on Tuesday, November 7, 2017 Medford Public Schools staff participated in our first Professional Development day for this school year. Elementary staff met at the McGlynn Elementary School and participated in grade level workshops on *Response to*

Intervention. Teachers 21, a consulting firm from Newton, MA worked with our staff to build a shared understanding of RTI fundamentals and help us consider our next steps. Staff learned about the structures, processes, and instructional practices needed for successful implementation of RTI. In addition, staff collaboratively self-assessed current capacities and planned for the next step for the implementation of RTI. The middle schools participated in *Study Island* as a Universal Screening/Behavioral Intervention tool. Teachers learned to utilize Study Island questions and developed a fall/winter screener exam for grades 6, 7 and 8. Administrators and teachers reviewed behavioral interventions and developed their own Pyramid to determine what is considered Tier 1, Tier II and Tier III. The Andrews and McGlynn met at Medford High School. Medford High/ Vocational and Curtis-Tufts staff participated in workshops regarding specific building based data collection in focus group discussions, and identified topics from their ongoing partnerships with Harvard and Boston College. Paraprofessionals collaborated with each other on online curriculum in three research based modules: independence, positive behavior supports and effective communication. The Fine Arts department focused on teaching pathways through the music curriculum as well as concepts in art education. Nurses, physical education and health education staff participated in Safety Care recertification training. As we all know it takes a village to ensure a successful professional development day. Our thanks to the many staff members who facilitated workshops. Dr. Ricciardelli reviewed some of the comments that teachers wrote on the evaluations.

Discussion:

Ms. DiBenedetto said that the budget spoke of adding more RTI. At this point are we using it well and do we need more money in the budget this year. Ms. Caldwell answered that we are piloting in grade 1. Training will continue with grade level staff from here on professional development days. She said she hopes to come to consensus in April on how to roll out in September for all. She did say more money would be helpful.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot to accept the report and place on file.

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Report on MSBA School Maintenance Study

Superintendent Belson reported that the Massachusetts School Building Authority released its recent survey/study of school building conditions across the Commonwealth. The assessments evaluated several key factors including building condition, general environment, capacity, technology, security and maintenance. The study was conducted by architectural and engineering experts who visited each specific building. School buildings that were slated for MSBA upgrades or recently constructed in partnership with MSBA were not included. The buildings were rated using a 4 point scale for general condition and general learning environment. A rating of 1 was the best and a rating of 4 was the lowest. All buildings were rated for capacity utilization. Under utilization was below 80% and over utilization was set at above 125% (state norms). Selected pages of the MSBA report is attached for your review (full report 96 pages). As we continue to

discuss building issues it will be an informative document for our reference and decision-making.

Discussion:

Ms. Cugno asked if they can find out how surrounding districts compared.

Superintendent Belson answered that he will give them area comparables . Ms. Cugno asked if the high ratings jeopardize funding. Superintendent Belson answered that we want to keep buildings up. Medford High School is a solid building but it needs upgrades.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Ms. Cugno to accept the report and place on file.

Vote:

Yes: 7

No: 0

Absent: 0

Recommendation to Implement Succession Plan for Superintendent of Schools

Mayor Burke introduced Superintendent Belson stating that he has been a dedicated Superintendent for over 23 years. She thanked him for making the transition to a new mayor very smooth. She announced that a Committee of the Whole has been scheduled with MASC for Monday evening November 27th to discuss our search criteria. She presented the Superintendent to give his report. Superintendent Belson read the following:

In June 2016 the Medford School Committee approved a succession plan for the position of Superintendent of Schools. A copy of that plan is attached to this report/recommendation. While it is within your discretion to keep, modify, and/or change the plan, it is a fundamental blueprint to begin the processes of succession and transition. It has been my privilege and honor to be an educator in the Medford Public Schools for fifty years and to serve as your Superintendent of Schools for twenty-three years. I have greatly benefitted from the high quality and diligence of the professionals, support staff, school committee members and citizens who have worked with me throughout my career. I am eternally grateful to them for making my tenure and responsibilities as productive and rewarding as reasonably possible. I have been very fortunate to have seen former students become teachers, administrators, and staff in our schools. I have had the experience of enrolling the children and grandchildren of former students. While no one does significant work alone, I have had the opportunity to build new schools, establish a full range of programs, and acquire hundreds of millions in grants for our community and school district. Understandably, there is always room for improvement, but much has been done and more will be done in the months ahead. No one gets to finish everything, but we have put a lot in place that will be a solid foundation for the future. Therefore, I am herein informing the Medford School Committee that it is my intention to retire from the position of Superintendent of the Medford Public Schools at the completion of my contract on June 30, 2018. This decision has been made without reference to any governmental change and/or issues that are in our community. It is simply the right period for me to spend more time with my family and to pursue special causes and interests that have not been possible given the schedule and work responsibility of an active School Superintendent. It is my intent and plan to be fully

engaged in the months ahead as your Superintendent. We have a lot of positive opportunities ahead of us and I will do everything possible to optimize and achieve our goals. Furthermore, I will be fully committed to ensuring a smooth and effective transition to new senior leadership.

Discussion:

Committee members commented and thanked the Superintendent for his dedication and commitment to the families and students of Medford.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot to accept the report and place on file.

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Mr. Skerry seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto to move Negotiations and Legal Matters to the end of the calendar.

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

New Business

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Florence Reilly. Mrs. Reilly was the mother of Director of Pupil Services Kathleen Medaglio.

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Marie Wildgrube Gomez. Mrs. Gomez was the mother of Brooks Teacher Lauren Gomez.

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Eileen Downing. Mrs. Downing was a teacher at the Franklin School for many years

A moment of silence was held.

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved that the Medford School Committee express its congratulations to Member Paulette Van der Kloot on the arrival of her new grandson, Ezra Muir Prokop.

On the motion of Ms. Cugno to invite John Costa for a meeting to acknowledge him for his role in the lights in the Caron Theater

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto to go to Executive Session at 8:25 p.m. for the purpose of Negotiations and Legal Matters pertaining to MTA grievance and upcoming legal matters.

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 0

The Committee returned from Executive Session at 10:46 p.m.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry seconded by Ms. Cugno the meeting was adjourned at 10:47 p.m.

Respectfully submitted:

Paulette Van der Kloot
Secretary

